

Week 6 — Small-Scale Research & Affinity Mapping

Today's focus

- Run a short research activity (peer or recruited participant)
- Code notes into themes
- Build an affinity map that can feed personas (Week 7)

Roles

Role	Name
Facilitator / timekeeper	
Moderator (asks questions)	
Notetaker	
Affinity lead	

Activity 1 — Research run (40–50 min)

Use Week 5 consent + guide. Keep sessions short (10–15 min each).

Session	Participant (initials / peer ID)	Duration	Key friction heard
1			
2			
3			

House rules: note facts vs interpretations; do not “fix” the design mid-interview.

Activity 2 — Coding pass (25 min)

Extract **sticky notes** (one insight per cell). Mark source session #.

Code / label	Insight (one line)	Source #	Quote fragment

Activity 3 — Affinity mapping (30 min)

Cluster codes into **3–5 themes**. Name each theme as a user need or tension.

Theme name	Supporting insights (IDs)	Design implication

Activity 4 — Synthesis claim (10 min)

Write one evidence-led claim:

Users struggle to _____ because _____, evidenced by _____.